

10-MINUTE AI AUTOMATION PLANNER

 AUTOMATION NEWBIE EDITION - EASY WINS

Perfect for beginners! This planner focuses on simple, low-risk automations that can save you time immediately. Start with these easy wins to build confidence before moving to more complex workflows.

 SALES AUTOMATION (EASY WINS)

Repeatable Task	Current Tool	Frequency	Potential AI Solution
Lead follow-up emails	Gmail/Outlook	Daily	Email templates with AI personalization (Mixmax, Boomerang)
Contact data entry	Excel/Google Sheets	Weekly	Auto-populate from business cards/LinkedIn (HubSpot, Pipedrive)
Meeting scheduling	Manual back-and-forth	Daily	Calendly + AI assistant integration (Clara, x.ai)
Basic lead scoring	Manual tracking	Weekly	Simple scoring rules based on engagement (Mailchimp, ActiveCampaign)
Social media prospect research	Manual LinkedIn browsing	Daily	AI-powered social listening tools (Sales Navigator, Hootsuite Insights)

Thank you note sending	Manual emails	After each meeting	Automated personalized thank you sequences (Woodpecker, Reply.io)
Proposal follow-ups	Manual reminders	Weekly	Automated follow-up sequences with engagement tracking (PandaDoc, DocuSign)
Lead source tracking	Manual spreadsheets	Daily	Automated UTM tracking and source attribution (Google Analytics, HubSpot)

OPERATIONS AUTOMATION (EASY WINS)

Repeatable Task	Current Tool	Frequency	Potential AI Solution
Invoice generation	Manual creation	Weekly	Auto-create from project completion (QuickBooks, FreshBooks)
Expense categorization	Manual entry	Daily	AI receipt scanning and sorting (Expensify, Receipt Bank)
File organization	Manual folder sorting	Daily	Auto-folder creation and tagging (Dropbox Smart Sync, Google Drive AI)
Basic reporting	Manual data compilation	Weekly	Automated weekly/monthly summaries (Zapier, Microsoft Power Automate)

Appointment reminders	Manual calls/texts	Daily	Smart SMS/email reminder sequences (Acuity, TimeTrade)
Inventory alerts	Manual checking	Weekly	Low-stock notifications and reorder suggestions (TradeGecko, inFlow)
Customer data backup	Manual exports	Monthly	Automated cloud backups with versioning (Backblaze, Carbonite)
Task assignment	Manual delegation	Daily	Smart task distribution based on workload (Asana, Monday.com)

MARKETING AUTOMATION (EASY WINS)

Repeatable Task	Current Tool	Frequency	Potential AI Solution
Social media posting	Manual posting	Daily	AI content scheduler with suggestions (Buffer, Later)
Email newsletter creation	Manual design	Weekly	AI-generated content from recent blog posts (Mailchimp, ConvertKit)
Image resizing for platforms	Manual Photoshop	Daily	Auto-resize for all social platforms (Canva, Figma)
Customer review responses	Manual replies	Daily	AI-drafted responses for approval (ReviewTrackers, Podium)

Basic SEO optimization	Manual keyword research	Weekly	AI keyword suggestions and meta tags (SEMrush, Ahrefs)
Content idea generation	Manual brainstorming	Weekly	AI-powered content suggestions based on trends (BuzzSumo, AnswerThePublic)
Hashtag research	Manual searching	Daily	AI hashtag recommendations for maximum reach (Hashtagify, All Hashtag)
Email subject line testing	Manual A/B testing	Weekly	AI-generated subject line variations (Send Check It, SubjectLine.com)

HR AUTOMATION (EASY WINS)

Repeatable Task	Current Tool	Frequency	Potential AI Solution
Interview scheduling	Manual coordination	Weekly	Auto-coordinate candidate availability (Calendly, YouCanBookMe)
Resume screening	Manual review	Daily	AI keyword matching and ranking (Workable, Greenhouse)
Employee birthday/anniversary reminders	Manual calendar	Monthly	Automated celebration notifications (BambooHR, Slack integrations)

Basic onboarding checklists	Paper/email lists	Per new hire	Smart task assignment and tracking (BambooHR, Zenefits)
Time-off request processing	Email requests	Weekly	Auto-approval for standard requests (TimeOff.Management, Calamari)
Employee handbook updates	Manual document editing	Quarterly	Version-controlled updates with notification (Notion, Confluence)
Training reminder sending	Manual emails	Monthly	Automated training schedule notifications (TalentLMS, Cornerstone)
Performance review scheduling	Manual calendar coordination	Quarterly	Automated review cycle management (15Five, Lattice)

TOP 3 RECOMMENDED AUTOMATIONS FOR BEGINNERS

1. Email Template Automation

- **Impact:** Save 2-3 hours/week
- **Difficulty:** Beginner
- **Tools:** Mixmax, Boomerang, or HubSpot
- **Setup Time:** 1-2 hours
- **Description:** Set up smart email templates that auto-personalize with recipient names, company details, and recent interactions. Start with follow-up sequences and welcome emails. Include dynamic fields for meeting scheduling and proposal attachments.

2. Social Media Scheduler

- **Impact:** Save 1-2 hours/week
- **Difficulty:** Beginner
- **Tools:** Buffer, Later, or Hootsuite
- **Setup Time:** 2-3 hours
- **Description:** Use tools like Buffer or Hootsuite with AI content suggestions to plan weeks of social media posts in advance. Include automated hashtag suggestions, optimal posting times, and cross-platform formatting.

3. Expense Receipt Scanning

- **Impact:** Save 1 hour/week
- **Difficulty:** Beginner
- **Tools:** Expensify, Receipt Bank, or QuickBooks
- **Setup Time:** 30 minutes
- **Description:** Implement AI-powered receipt scanning that automatically categorizes expenses, extracts key data, and exports to your accounting software. Include mileage tracking and automatic expense report generation.



IMPLEMENTATION CHECKLIST

Week 1-2: Foundation Setup

- Choose your first automation (recommend email templates)
- Set up chosen tool account
- Create basic templates/rules
- Test with small group

Week 3-4: Expansion

- Add second automation
- Monitor first automation performance
- Train team members on new processes
- Document procedures

Month 2: Optimization

- Implement third automation
 - Review and optimize existing automations
 - Measure time savings
 - Plan next phase automations
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QUICK START TIPS FOR BEGINNERS

1. **Start Small:** Choose one process that takes 15+ minutes daily
 2. **Test First:** Run automations alongside manual processes initially
 3. **Document Everything:** Keep notes on what works and what doesn't
 4. **Get Team Buy-in:** Train colleagues on new automated processes
 5. **Measure Results:** Track time saved and errors reduced
 6. **Scale Gradually:** Add new automations only after mastering current ones
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READY FOR MORE?

Once you've mastered these easy wins, you'll be ready for:

- Multi-step workflows
 - Cross-platform integrations
 - Advanced lead nurturing
 - Predictive analytics
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WANT THIS BUILT FOR YOU?

Let SKAL create your automations — Book a free strategy call.

Ready to save hours every week with AI automation? Our experts will analyze your current processes and implement these automations for you, so you can focus on growing your business instead of managing repetitive tasks.



Book Your Free Strategy Call Today *Transform your workflow in 30 days or less*

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